

In case the PATH environment doesn't have a specific directory, then you can also add them in the PATH variable using this line in the .bashrc file.

- `export PATH=~/.bin:$PATH`

After execution, the directory will be included in the PATH environment from a new terminal session.

Shell also needs to re-read the file to update with the latest changes in the .bashrc file. This is done through sourcing in the following way:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ . .bashrc`

Here (.) dot works for source command, a shell builtin that acts as a file of shell commands treating this as input from the keyboard only.

Note: In Ubuntu, the system automatically updates a ~/.bin directory for the PATH variable on executing .bashrc file. So once you log out and login directories are updated and work seamlessly.

Ideal locations for script

The ~/bin directory is the ideal place to save scripts mainly for personal use. Directory at /usr/local/bin is the traditional location for scripts that everyone on a system can use. Whereas /usr/local/sbin directory is intended for scripts to be used by system administrators. On the other hand, local compiled software or programs should be saved in the /usr/local directories not in the /usr/bin or /bin. Linux Filesystem Hierarchy Standard allows only specific directories and files in the system that are maintained and supplied by Linux distributors.

Formatting script

Shell scripting's primary goal is to ease in performing tasks. There are several formatting tricks, modifications, and adaptation to get the desired output. A script must be easy to read and understand for proper maintenance.

Long options names

Most of the command can be used in both short and long name options such as ls command in the following way.

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ ls -ad`

Or

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ ls --all --directory`

On execution, both commands will give the same results. Though shorter versions are more preferred for using on the command line still when creating shell scripts these long options improve readability.